

Chapter 110-1

Liang Wanwan had indeed cried for a long time last night. When she looked in the mirror after waking up early, she was startled by her own eyes.

Even when she went out to buy breakfast, she avoided people.

Sad emotions are most easily stirred up in the loneliness of deep night. She had cried her fill before falling asleep.

Before falling asleep, she was still thinking: From now on, I shouldn't like Chen Mian anymore.

But the first thing she did upon waking up early in the morning was instinctively reach for that sketchbook, just like usual. Only after flipping through the pillow did she suddenly remember—she was at her sister's home.

And her sketchbook had already been washed by Liang Xinran.

By that biological sister she had only just met.

The two of them looked quite alike, but Liang Wanwan hated being compared.

Especially for Qiu Zimin, who felt tremendously guilty toward the biological daughter who had just been brought back from that poor, remote place. She looked at her through a thick filter, which made Liang Wanwan—the biological daughter who had always been by her side—seem insignificant.

When Liang Wanwan thought about this, she couldn't help but cry again.

Only after crying did she carefully go wash up.

Now, eating breakfast with Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu, the two of them were very quiet—somewhat like eating in the school cafeteria.

After finishing the meal, Liang Wanwan got up to clean up, but Liang Shi took over. "You rest. I'll do it."

Liang Wanwan responded with an "oh."

She continued sitting on the sofa with Xu Qingzhu, chatting about movies. Some of her attention had been diverted.

But no matter how great Yang Shuyan was, she couldn't completely offset the sadness of losing Chen Mian's sketchbook.

Liang Wanwan lowered her eyes, seemingly looking earnestly at Yang Shuyan's poster, her whole person emanating a restrained, melancholic air.

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her thoughtfully a few times. She didn't offer to give Liang Wanwan the poster that Yang Shuyan had specifically given her. Instead, she asked: "Is there any personalized autograph you'd like?"¹

Liang Wanwan raised her head, her expression startled. She asked in disbelief: "Are you asking me?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded. "Yes. I can't give you this set, but the next time I see Yang Shuyan, I can help you get a personalized autograph."

She had heard that fans really loved these.

For example, her younger sister Xu Qingya.

And this was the only way Xu Qingzhu could think of to comfort her.

Liang Wanwan hesitated for a moment before saying somewhat embarrassedly: "If it's not too much trouble, I'd like the line—'How can one withstand the fierce evening wind.'"²

Xu Qingzhu asked: "Is that from that poem?"

"Mm." Liang Wanwan said: "I really like that line."

Xu Qingzhu agreed.

After Liang Shi finished cleaning up the kitchen and came out, Xu Qingzhu had already changed and was ready to go to work.

Liang Shi asked Liang Wanwan what she planned to do today. Liang Wanwan said she was going back to school—she had classes in the afternoon.

Liang Shi was worried about her condition and hesitated, wanting to keep her for another day. But Liang Wanwan let out a soft breath and showed a smile. "I'm really fine."

You could tell she hadn't fully recovered, but she was much better than last night.

After confirming with Liang Wanwan multiple times, Liang Shi finally said: "Then I'll take you to school later."

Liang Wanwan nodded and said okay.

She had always been quiet and wasn't particularly close to Liang Shi.

Being together now, they naturally didn't have much to say.

Liang Shi still wanted to see Xu Qingzhu off to work, but Xu Qingzhu waved the keyring on her finger. "I'll go by myself."

Liang Shi stood at the entryway. Xu Qingzhu braced herself against the shoe cabinet as her feet slipped nimbly into her high heels. She said to her quietly: "Rest for a bit, then take Wanwan."

Liang Shi saw her out the door and stood at the entrance for a while. Only after Xu Qingzhu got on the elevator and left did she close the door.

But when she turned around, she found Liang Wanwan staring at her without blinking.

Their eyes met.

Liang Wanwan was the first to lower her head. She looked a bit strange.

Liang Shi took the initiative to ask: "What's wrong?"

Just now, Liang Wanwan's gaze had contained a hint of longing, as well as curiosity and shock —altogether a very complex look.

Liang Wanwan instinctively shook her head, but after a moment she said: "Jie, just now you....."

She paused, her tone carrying a hint of disbelief: "You looked like a Waiting-Wife Stone."³

Liang Shi: "?"

-
1. "To 簽" (To qiān) refers to a personalized autograph where the celebrity writes a specific message "To [fan's name]" along with their signature, making it a unique keepsake for that particular fan. ⇐
 2. "怎敵他晚來風急" is a famous line from the classical Chinese poem "声声慢" (Shēng Shēng Mǎn / "Slow, Slow Tune") by the renowned Song Dynasty poetess Li Qingzhao (李清照). The full line describes the poet's deep sorrow and loneliness. The phrase roughly translates to "How can one withstand the fierce evening wind," expressing a sense of vulnerability and melancholy. The character "晚" (wǎn, meaning "evening/late") in the line shares the same character as in Liang Wanwan's name (梁晚晚), giving it personal significance to her. ⇐
 3. "望妻石" (Wàng Qī Shí, "Waiting-Wife Stone" or "Husband-Watching Rock") refers to a famous rock formation in Chinese folklore. According to legend, a faithful wife stood watching and waiting for her husband's return for so long that she turned to stone. It has become a symbol of devoted, longing love. Liang Wanwan is teasing Liang Shi for looking like she was longingly watching Xu Qingzhu leave. ⇐